

Fields	Description
<device>	The device/partition (by /dev location or UUID) that contain a file system.
<mount point>	The directory on your root file system (aka mount point) from which it will be possible to access the content of the device/partition (note: swap has no mount point). Mount points should not have spaces in the names.
<file system type>	Type of file system.
<options>	Mount options of access to the device/partition.
<dump>	Enable or disable backing up of the device/partition. This field is usually set to 0, which disables it.
<pass num>	Controls the order in which fsck checks the device/partition for errors at boot time. The root device should be 1. Other partitions should be 2, or 0 to disable checking.

Parameters of an fstab entry

[Device] [Mount Point]
[File System Type] [Options]
[Dump] [Pass]

Editing the fstab files involves multiple parameters, refer to the Ubuntu website for the detailed steps needed to achieve this.

<https://help.ubuntu.com/community/Fstab>

Once you are done adding the entry to fstab, you should be able to access your windows documents in linux, do the same for your media files as well. Keep backup files separate and only accessible in Linux as it is a much safer environment from malicious software. Now, all your documents will be available in one central location no matter which operating system you are using.

Intelligent naming

When making folders for cataloging your files, ensure that

- The folder names are short and to the point.
- Avoid having way too many folders under any category.
- Maintain a nomenclature method and remain consistent to that method.
- Keep your ongoing work separate from the work that has been completed.
- When there are too many subfolders then consider grouping them under alphabetized folders.
- If you absolutely have to keep duplicates then have short-cuts instead of copying the

entire content completely. However, don't do the same for back-up, obviously!

Archive, backup and catalogue

You can't store everything on your machine and even if you can, then don't! Keep a separate folder for archive purposes, maintain a similar folder structure as you do for your normal files. Whenever you come across a file that you might need in the future but have no use of for now, archive it. Then, as soon as you hit 4.7GB or 9.4GB for those using Dual layer DVDs, burn



Circular labels using cdrLabel

it onto a DVD. You might want to check out cdrLabel. Insert your DVDs into the DVD drive and run the software, it'll scan through the entire contents and provide you with an option to print out labels for jewel cases. The paid version provides for more customisability options for the labels and to edit images. Further, functionality is enhanced by means of various plug-ins available on their

website. You can make jewel case inlays or labels for pasting directly onto the discs. Using a file list generator can prove to be a great alternative to the indexing service in your operating system.

Index your directories

Once you are done with all the rearranging of the files, add the newly created folders to the Indexing service. Access the 'Indexing Options' from the Start Menu, Select the Modify option and add all the folders you want the OS to index for you. This will cause the indexer to index all the files that are in the included folders. If it so happens that some of the files were skipped by the indexer, then you will need to add the file type to the indexer. In order to do this, switch to the 'File Types' tab under advanced options and include whichever file type was skipped initially and rebuild the index. This helps out with the search function, however, enabling the search function does reduce your system's performance a bit. If your computer is of a newer generation then this would hardly register a dip in your computer's performance.

Final defrag

To drive a nail in the coffin of your clutter problem would be to finish off with a round of defragmentation. Try out O&O Defrag which offers multiple

ways to defragment your drive. You can defragment using any of the 5 available options viz. according to Stealth, Space, Name, Last Accessed & Last Modified. Last accessed has been proven to offer slight boost in system performance.

An ongoing process

Maintenance is an ongoing process, though following the aforementioned steps will help out with your situation, it would only be effective for a short term. Soon enough more and more files will pop up here



O&O Defragmenter

and there, specially if you have multiple persons using your computer.

So follow these steps:

- Make a schedule for computer maintenance. There might be atleast once a month that you like to clean up your desk and your computer. If not, then assign one.
- Delete unwanted & unused files regularly. Run Ccleaner or any similar software. You may schedule a task for the same.

Voila!

That's it! You are done. If you've religiously followed the steps mentioned above then by now you have probably done away with a lot of unwanted files and now have a good system in place to manage all your files. ■

Tried something creative using the above tips? Drop us an e-mail at readersletters@thinkdigit.com or post it on our Facebook page at www.facebook.com/thinkdigit or on Twitter @digitindia